

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

It's time to fix the printer!



Learning Outcome

Present advice on solving technical problems in a work context and appropriate for the interlocutor.

Ask your partner:

- When was the last time you experienced a technical issue?
- What did you do?

Can Do Statements

- I can problem-solve a technical issue.
- I can use expressions like *of course* and *in fact*.
- I can ask for, give and respond to advice.





Let's Explore!

Janet gets some bad news. What's going to happen with the printer?



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Janet:** Hi Joe. I'm very glad to see you!
- Technician:** So, your printer has been giving you problems?
- Janet:** Actually, as of this morning, our printer hasn't given us anything!
- Technician:** Have you heard any unusual noises?
- Janet:** No, it has the same gentle hum as always.
- Technician:** Let's open this side panel and look inside. Ah, of course! The toner has run completely dry. Did you notice anything unusual before today?
- Janet:** Yes, all my sheets were printing out with streaks yesterday. In fact, I think I had several sheets print out where the ink looked a little blotchy. Do you want me to show you one?
- Technician:** I hate to tell you but the answer will be costly. The machine has become outdated. You'll need to replace it.
- Janet:** That's surprising. It's not that old. In fact, we purchased it less than three years ago. Aside from the toner it has run perfectly until now.
- Technician:** Unfortunately the industry has been producing new toners that do not match the old machines.
- Janet:** Would you advise me to find an old model with a good toner?
- Technician:** Of course, but you will have the same issue again once the toner expires. I recommend a new machine.
- Janet:** Thanks for the advice. Would you suggest inkjet or laser?
- Technician:** I would go with laser. It's more expensive however they are faster and usually less problematic than the inkjet.
- Janet:** Of course, we'll put it in the budget immediately.



Let's Practice!

Does it look blotchy? We can solve this problem together!

Instructions: Read the sentences. Complete the sentences with words from the box below. Use the sentences to model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

1. It has the same _____ as always.
2. All the sheets were printing out with _____ and the ink looked _____.
3. Let's open this _____ and look inside.
4. The _____ has run completely _____.
5. The machine has become _____.
6. You'll need _____ it.
7. _____ printers are more expensive however they are faster and usually less _____ than the _____.

blotchy	gentle hum
package	side panel
to replace	streaks
inkjet	laser
toner	outdated
dry	



Let's Practice!

Let's take a look at your printer.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. answer / costly / the / be / but / tell / . / will / hate / you / to / I
2. with / good / a / to / find / an / model / Would / you / old / me / toner / ? / advise
3. you / suggest / ? / Would / or / inkjet / laser
4. new / a / machine / recommend / . / I
5. in / that / . / keep / mind / I'll
6. ? / replacement / Do / if / to / me / an / want / find / model / can / you / see / old / I
7. with / laser / I / . / would / go





Extension Activity

This gadget isn't working.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Choose a gadget from your office that you think does not work properly.
- Ask a partner for advice on what to do with it.
- Respond to your partner's advice (use "in fact" when possible).
- When you are finished, switch roles. Your partner will ask you for advice and you will give him or her advice.
- Decide whether you are going to keep the gadget or follow your partner's advice.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I identify a gadget that isn't working properly.

☐ ☐

I ask questions on how to fix it.

☐ ☐

I give and follow advice.

☐ ☐

I use "in fact" when responding to advice.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **side panel** (noun): a removable piece from a printer that allows you to see inside a printer
e.g. Let's open this side panel and look inside the printer.
- **outdated** (adjective): no longer useful because of being old-fashioned
e.g. The machine has become outdated.
- **toner** (noun): a type of ink used in printers
e.g. The toner has run completely dry.
- **to expire** (verb): to not be of use anymore
e.g. You will have the same issue again once the toner expires.
- **laser printer** (noun): a printer that produces good quality printouts by means of a laser
e.g. I'm thinking of getting a laser printer.
- **inkjet** (noun): a printer that uses very small jets to blow ink onto paper in order to form letters, numbers, etc.
e.g. I have an inkjet printer at home.





Learning Points

Using Expressions like *of course* and *in fact*

Using *of course*

- To say "yes" as an answer to a question.
- "Do you want help with the printer?"
"**Of course.**"
- To say that you agree or disagree with someone.
- "I guess I need a new printer."
"**Of course** you do."
- To say something that you believe someone probably already knows or will not be surprised about.
- "**Of course.** The printer has run out of paper."

Using *in fact*

- To add something to what you have just said, especially something that may seem surprising.
- The printer is new. **In fact**, we purchased it less than two months ago.





Learning Points

Asking for, Giving and Responding to Advice

In the workplace, you will often be requested to give, ask for, and respond to advice.

The **modal verb** *should* is the most common way of giving advice. However, there are other ways to do that.

• *I hate to tell you but ... + phrase*

I hate to tell you this but it is not going to be cheap.

• *Do you want me to + verb?*

Do you want me to check if the light is on?

Other ways to ask for, give and respond to advice:

Asking for Advice	Giving Advice	Responding to Advice
<i>Would you suggest + verb</i>	<i>I would go with ... + noun</i>	<i>Thanks for the advice.</i>
<i>Would you recommend + verb</i>	<i>I recommend + noun / -ing</i>	<i>I'll keep it in mind.</i>

When it comes to giving advice, we normally use the word *recommend*. It is, therefore, important to understand common patterns with the word *recommend*.

1. *recommend + (that) + clause*

I recommend that you buy a more modern printer.

1. *strongly + recommend + pronoun + verb*

I strongly recommend you buy a more modern printer.

1. *recommend + -ing*

I recommend buying a more modern printer.

